

19<sup>th</sup> September-2022.

## Introduction To Word Classes

There are 8 word classes in English ; namely.

- \* Nouns
- \* Verbs
- \* Pronouns
- \* Adjectives.
- \* Adverbs.
- \* Prepositions.
- \* Conjunctions.
- \* Determiners.

### Nouns.

- \* Nouns are words used to name a person, place, thing, an animal or a concept

e.g ÷ A person ÷ father, mother, doctor, Sriyani.....

Place ÷ University, School, temple.....

Thing ÷ Pen, Book, Table, Chair.....

an animal ÷ Cat, Dog, Cow, Parrot.....

a Concept ÷ beauty, goodness, kindness.....

### Verbs.

- \* Verbs are words which denote an action, a happening or a state of being.

e.g ÷ action ÷ go, come, eat, sleep, write.....

happening ÷ fall, rise, bloom, float.....

state of being ÷ am, is, are, was, were...

\* I go to school by bus.

\* A tree has fallen across the road.

\* I am a University Student.

## Pronouns

\* A pronoun is a word used in place of a noun.

e.g: I, We, you, he, She, It, they etc.

\* Kumara is a student.

\* He attends Anuradhapura Central College.

\* Sunila and Nimali work in a garment factory.

\* They travel by the same bus.

## Adjectives

- Adjectives are used to describe nouns.
- Some examples of adjectives are tall, short, fat, thin, beautiful, educated and happy.
- They may be used before a noun or after be verbs. (am, is, are etc)

\* Asanka is a tall boy.

\* There is a beautiful picture on the wall.

\* My sister is educated.

\* I am happy.

## Adverbs

\* Adverbs are words used to describe verbs. (Add verbs)

\* Ruwan runs fast

\* My students usually work hard.

\* Many students came to the university yesterday.

\* We will wait here.

\* They crossed the road carefully.

## Prepositions.

\* Prepositions show the relationship between two nouns.

\* The students of Rajarata University.

\* They gave a present to Raja.

\* They also show the relationship between a noun and a pronouns.

E.g. • A friend of mine.

• I received a letter from him.

\* Prepositions can also show the relationship between a noun and a verb.

\* We sat on the river bank.

\* The man fell off the tree.

## Conjunctions.

\* Conjunctions join words, phrases and sentences together.

E.g. • Jack and Jill went up the hill.

\* I came home and had my lunch.

\* You can go home or stay at a hotel.

\* I like mangoes because they are tasty.

\* Although the weather was bad, we went out to play.

\* If you like, you can go home.

\* Shall we wait here till your friends come?

## Determiners

\* Determiners include.

• Articles - A/An and The.

A = indefinite article

e.g. ÷ a man, a tree, an apple an hour.

\* A becomes An before vowel sounds.

The = definite article e.g. ÷ the man, the tree, the elephant.

## \* Demonstratives

- this, that, these, those
- this dog, this man, this picture.
- that dog, that man, that picture.
- these dogs, these men, these pictures.
- those dogs, those men, those pictures.

## \* Quantifiers (Words that show quantities or numbers)

- Some, every, each, any, much more, most, all, both, no, none, a lot of.
- Lots of, plenty of etc.

## Activity.

Put the underlined words, phrases in the <sup>right</sup> column.

Most, you, aware, fires, break out, forested, Various, World, Animal, adversely, by, Occur, often, any, intervention, in, Valuable forest, Recently, the, range, are, integral, of, and, when, ecological, that, too, any, starts, habitat, wild, or, take place, over, reported, every few years, United States, also, bush, can, three.

| Nouns         | Verbs    | Pronouns | Adjectives       | Adverbs   | Prepositions | Conjunctions | Determiners |
|---------------|----------|----------|------------------|-----------|--------------|--------------|-------------|
| fires         | breakout | you      | aware            | adversely | by           | and          | Most        |
| world         | forested | that     | various          | often     | in           | or           | an          |
| Animal        | Occur    |          | valuable forest  | recently  | of           |              | the         |
| intervention  | starts   |          | integral         | When.     |              |              |             |
| range         | take     |          | ecological       | too       |              |              |             |
| are           | reported |          | any              | over      |              |              |             |
| habitat       | can      |          | wild             | also      |              |              |             |
| place         |          |          | every few years. |           |              |              |             |
| United States |          |          |                  |           |              |              |             |
| bush          |          |          |                  |           |              |              |             |
| can           |          |          |                  |           |              |              |             |

10<sup>th</sup> October - 2022

\* money - uncountable  
\* Rupees/dollars - countable  
We can use.

## Nouns

bull-male animals  
are using

A noun is a word used to name a person, thing, an animal or a concept.

- \* teacher, doctor, driver, father, mother, child (Person)
- \* university, school, fair, temple, market. (Place)
- \* table, chair, pen, pencil, computer (thing)
- \* dog, cat, parrot, deer, donkey (animal)
- \* anger, hunger, beauty, kindness, goodness (Concept)

idea/idea/theory (equal words)

Concepts can't be seen or touched, they limit only to words.

### Plural Nouns.

- \* By adding an "s" to the singular noun.

| Singular        | Plural.     |
|-----------------|-------------|
| • a/the boy     | → boys.     |
| • a/the cat     | → cats.     |
| • a/the teacher | → teachers. |
| • a/the book    | → books.    |
| • a/the river   | → rivers.   |

- \* When the singular noun ends in s, x, z, ss, ch, and sh "es" is added.

| Singular.     | Plural.    |
|---------------|------------|
| • a/the bus   | → buses.   |
| • a/the box   | → boxes.   |
| • a/the quiz  | → quizzes. |
| • a/the class | → classes. |
| • a/the match | → matches. |
| • a/the bush  | → bushes.  |

- \* Most of the nouns ending in "o" take "es" and make their plurals.

### Singular

- a/the mango
- a/the buffalo
- a/the hero
- a/the mosquito
- a/the potato

### Plural

- mangoes.
- buffaloes.
- heroes.
- mosquitoes.
- potatoes.

- \* All the nouns ending in "y" with a consonant in front of the marginal "y" drop y and add "ies".

### Singular

- a/the baby.
- a/the lady
- a/the country
- a/the city.
- a/the copy

### Plural

- babies.
- ladies.
- Countries.
- cities.
- Copies.

- \* but the nouns ending in "y" with a vowel in front take only an "s".

### Singular

- a/the boy.
- a/the monkey.
- a/the toy
- a/the key

### Plural

- boys.
- monkeys.
- toys.
- keys.

## Other ways of making plurals.

### Interval vowel change.

#### Singular

- a/the man
- a/the woman
- a/the tooth
- a/the foot.
- a/the mouse.

#### Plural

- men.
- women.
- teeth.
- feet.
- mice.

\* By dropping final "f" or "fe" and adding "ves".

| <u>Singular</u> | <u>Plural</u> |
|-----------------|---------------|
| • a/the knife   | knives.       |
| • a/the wife    | wives.        |
| • a/the leaf    | leaves.       |
| • a/the life    | lives.        |
| • a/the loaf    | loaves.       |

\* By adding "en" or "ren".

| <u>Singular</u> | <u>Plural</u> |
|-----------------|---------------|
| • a/the ox      | oxen.         |
| • a/the child.  | children.     |

\* Zero sound nouns.

\* Same word is used as singular and plural noun.

| <u>Singular</u>                     | <u>Plural</u> |
|-------------------------------------|---------------|
| • a/the deer.                       | deer.         |
| • a/the sheep.                      | sheep.        |
| • a/the cattle.                     | cattle.       |
| • a/the dozen.                      | dozen.        |
| • a/the cannon <del>(cannons)</del> | cannon.       |

\* Foreign plurals.

| <u>Singular</u>     | <u>Plural</u>                      |
|---------------------|------------------------------------|
| • a/the radius.     | radii. (infinity) <del>radii</del> |
| • a/the memorandum. | memoranda.                         |
| • a/the medium.     | media.                             |
| • a/the criterion   | criteria.                          |

## Types of Nouns. (Four types)

### (1) Common Nouns.

Names given in common to refer to the same class or types.

e.g. + man, boy, desk, house, tree, table, book etc.

### (02) Proper Nouns.

Names given to individual **people**, places and animals.

e.g : Palitha, Sumana, London, Colombo, Pidurutthala -agala, Mahaweli etc.

\* A proper nouns should always begin with a capital letter.

### (03) Abstract Nouns.

These nouns refer to concepts and can't be seen or touched.

e.g : Poverty, truth, purity, sadness, kindness, beauty, anger, hunger etc.

### (04) Collective Nouns.

Nouns that ~~are~~ refer to a large number but considered as one unit.

e.g : group, crowd, set, galaxy, bunch, gang, class etc.

(a group of people, a galaxy of stars, a bunch of flowers, a class of fish)

### Gender

(difference/variation.)

Gender is the distinction of sex. There are two sexes but gender comes under four headings.

#### \* Masculine Gender.

Refer to all male nouns, boy, uncle, father, cock, king etc.

#### \* Feminine Gender.

Refer to all female nouns, girl, aunt, mother, hen, queen etc.

### \* Common Gender.

Refer to either sex (in common without gender distinction)  
eg: Child, teacher, friend, doctor, baby, student, parent etc.

### \* Neuter Gender.

~~Refer to either sex (in common without gender distinction)~~  
eg: Refer to things (without sex)  
eg: Table, Chair, tree, book, school etc.

## Count and Non-Count Nouns.

### Count Nouns.

eg: a tree, two trees, three trees etc.

We should always use a/an or the before singular count nouns.

eg: a boy or the boy, an elephant or the elephant.

### Non-Count Nouns.

They can not be counted and always stand as singular.

eg: water, sugar, flour, sand, rice, medicine, hair etc.

Money is uncountable. But rupees, hundred <sup>should be</sup> and <sup>are</sup> countable.

## A Noun Phrase.

A noun phrase is a group of words (without a verb) that functions as a noun.

eg: the students of Rojarata University, the cat in the box, a handsome boy, a difficult lesson, handworking student etc.

## A Noun Clause.

A noun clause is a group of words (with a verb) that functions as a noun.

eg: the girl who has long hair, the cow that gives us milk, the book with which I read last night etc.

## Nouns Cont.

### Position of the Noun.

At the beginning of a sentence as the subject.

- \* Sri Lanka is a small island.
- \* Sunil goes to school by bus.
- \* Cat is a domestic animal.
- \* Knife is used for cutting.

After the main verb as the object.

- \* I am writing a letter.
- \* Kasun bought a car.
- \* Our teacher advised Kumara.

After be verbs (am, is, are) as subject complement.

- \* My sister ~~is~~ a teacher.
- \* Those boys are cricketers.
- \* My name is Prasanna.

After the object as object complement.

- \* I thought him a god.
- \* We elected Mr. Silva the president.

After a preposition.

- \* The book is on the table.
- \* I am working with a computer.
- \* We participated in a meeting.
- \* Look at the picture.
- \* The dog ran along the road.

### Activity.

Pick out the nouns in the following passage.

There are many things that people could do in life.  
Being a student it is too early to take a decision  
about my future career. Yet it would be nice

if I could choose what I like to do when I become an adult.

Looking at many people who are engaged in successful professions, I decided to become a teacher. Teaching is a noble profession. A teacher imparts knowledge to innocent children; who are the country's future. A teacher has the responsibility of creating disciplined individuals to a society. Hence a teacher renders an invaluable service to the younger generation.

(This is adjective)

(This is adjective)

Being a teacher, one can enjoy being with young children. It is really interesting to work with children. That's why I mostly like this job. I would like to be of help to them by enhancing their talents through various extracurricular activities.

(This is noun)

(Subject)

A teacher is a respected person in the society. She has to be of example to her students. A teacher has to work only for half a day. She has enough time to attend to her work at home in the afternoon. That is also one of the reasons why I like teaching. However, my choice in life is to select a good profession that could make me happy. I am sure being a teacher would help me to achieve my goal.

27<sup>th</sup> October-2022.

### Verbs.

A verb is a word that indicates all actions, a happening or a state of being.

E.g:- eat

Go

run

sing

sleep

} actions.

fall

bloom

rise.

blow

withier.

} happenings.

am

is

are

was

were

} State of being.

# Verb Activities

## Helping Verbs

- (6) will be (Be verb)
- (7) had
- (15) didn't
- (27) had
- (32) didn't
- (40) didn't

## Main Verbs

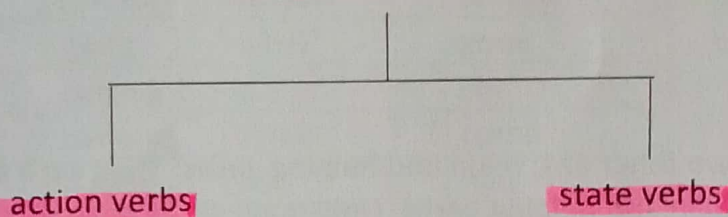
- (1) Woke up - irregular verb.
- (2) found - irregular verb.
- (3) had - irregular verb.
- (4) remembered - regular verb.
- (5) hoped - regular verb.
- (7) do - irregular verb.
- (8) was - irregular verb.
- (9) washed - regular verb.
- (10) had - irregular verb.
- (11) Changed - regular verb.
- (12) left - irregular verb.
- (13) Walked - regular verb.
- (14) waited - regular verb.
- (15) Come - irregular verb.
- (18) came - irregular verb.
- (19) got - irregular verb.
- (20) were - irregular verb.
- (21) got - irregular verb.
- (22) sat - irregular verb.
- (23) remembered - regular verb.
- (24) won - irregular verb.
- (25) Came - irregular verb.
- (26) wished - regular verb.
- (28) been - irregular verb.
- (29) fell - irregular verb.
- (30) was - irregular verb.
- (31) hurt - irregular verb.
- (33) run - irregular verb.
- (34) Stopped - regular verb.
- (35) got - irregular verb.
- (36) went - irregular verb.
- (37) heard - irregular verb.
- (38) saw - irregular verb.
- (39) felt - irregular verb.
- (41) feel - irregular verb.

## Verbs

A verb is a word that indicates an action, a happening or a state of being.

|           |   |         |         |   |            |      |   |                |
|-----------|---|---------|---------|---|------------|------|---|----------------|
| E.g.: eat | } | actions | fall    | } | happenings | am   | } | state of being |
| Go        |   |         | bloom   |   |            | is   |   |                |
| run       |   |         | rise    |   |            | are  |   |                |
| sing      |   |         | blow    |   |            | was  |   |                |
| sleep     |   |         | whither |   |            | were |   |                |

verbs are of two types

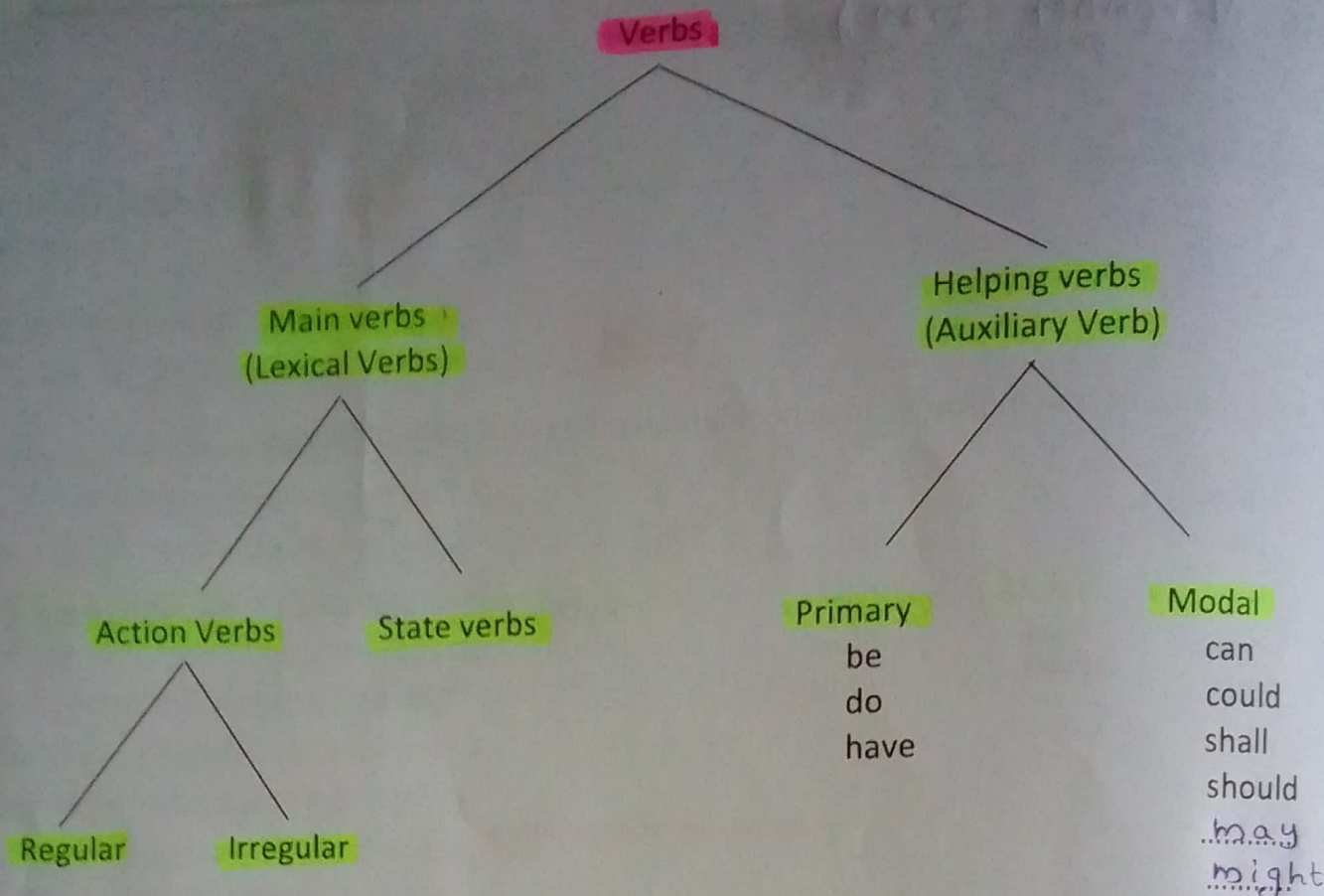


Verbs that denote actions are called action verbs (eat, go, run etc.) and those that express a state of being are called state verbs (am, is, are etc.)

E.g.: Raja walks to school every morning. (action verb)

Raja is a student. (state verb)

Verbs can also be classified as main verbs ( lexical verbs ) and helping verbs(auxiliary verbs).



Some verbs can have two functions; main and helping verbs. Thus verb **do**, **be**, and **have** may function as both main and helping verbs. Only main verbs have meanings of their own. Helping verbs on the other hand add a meaning to the main verb of a sentence.

My sister is a teacher.

I do my homework every evening.

They have a new car.

My sister is suffering from fever.

I do not(don't) like tea.

They have built a big house.

Therefore, when a main verb is introduced, it is better to use it with **to + verb**.  
e.g.: to go, to sing, to sing, to do, to be and to have etc.

In regular verbs, the two forms: simple past form and past participle are formed by adding "d" or "ed" to the base form (play, played, played/save, saved, saved). If those two forms are formed using another method, such verbs are called irregular verbs. (go, went, gone)

primary auxiliary verbs help the main verb to form tense, questions and negation whereas modal auxiliary verbs express speaker's attitude towards the action.

e.g.: I sing

Do you sing? (question)

I do not sing. (negation)

I am singing. (tense)

I shall sing. (willingness)

I can sing. (ability)

I should sing. (obligation)

Any main verb (other than verb to be) has five forms.

| Base form (v1) | Singular Form (v2) | "ing" form (v3) | Simple past form (v4) | Past participle (v5) |
|----------------|--------------------|-----------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| play           | plays              | playing         | played                | played               |
| go             | goes               | going           | went                  | gone                 |
| cut            | cuts               | cutting         | cut                   | cut                  |
| come           | comes              | coming          | came                  | come                 |
| have           | has                | having          | had                   | had                  |
| sing           | sings              | singing         | sang                  | sung                 |
| be             | Is/am              | being           | Was/were              | been                 |

\*Verb to have is unique among other verbs in that it can function as an action verb or a state verb.

I have three sisters. - state verb

I have my lunch at 2 'o' clock. - action verb

\*Verb "be" has eight forms, namely; be, am, is, are, was, were, being, been.

### Uses of the five forms.

(1) Base form (V1) is used

(a) In the simple present active statements when the subject is plural.

e.g. Dogs bark at night.

Rupa and Kamala work in a garment factory.

(b) In questions and negative statements of the simple present and past active sentences.

e.g. Do you want this?

Did you see my new house?

Does she speak English?

I do not like sweets.

My friend does not wear shoes to school.

(c) With modal auxiliary verbs in active voice.

e.g. I can sing well.

They will help you.

You should obey your parents.

(d) After the preposition "to"

e.g. I want some water to drink.

Ask them to come in.

To see is to believe.

(e) After the object of a sentence.

e.g. They have seen me dance.

I heard you sing.

(f) In commands, requests and instructions.

e.g. Turn right!

Please, come in.

Read the lesson and answer the given questions.

Go straight and turn right at the first junction.

2. Singular form (V2) may be used in the simple present tense active statements when the subject is singular.

e.g. Nimal goes to school by bus.

Kamala cooks tastily.

3. Present participle (ing form) (V3) is used.

a) In continuous tenses

e.g. My father **is** watching news on Tv.

I **was** reading a book.

It **has been** raining since morning.

b) After a preposition other than "to".

e.g. Thank you **for** coming.

**After** coming to the university, I improved my knowledge of English.  
The teacher explained the lesson **by** drawing a diagram.  
I usually brush my teeth **before** going to bed.

4. Simple past form (V4) is used in the simple past tense affirmative (positive) sentences.  
e.g. They entered the university last year.  
I met your brother at party.  
Rosy wrote a letter to her mother yesterday.

5. We use past participle

a) In perfect tenses.

e.g. Our dog **has** bit my neighbor.

The train **had** already left when I went to the station.

I **shall have** gone to the U.K by the time you complete your degree.

b) In passive voice (subject+ be+ p.p).

e.g. The boy **was** punished because of his misconduct.

Stamps **are** not sold in bookshops.

The patient **has been** advised not to smoke.

The election **will be** held next year.

### Verb "to be"

Verb "to be" expresses a state of being. It goes on telling us something more about the subject of a sentence. What follows verb to be completes the subject. Therefore, it is called the subject complement.

e.g. Ramesh is a student.

Your story is interesting.

You are a good friend.

**a student, interesting** and **a good friend** complete the three subjects; **Ramesh, your story** and **you** and they on the other hand say something more about the three subjects

The complement can be a noun.

They are farmers.

My sister is a teacher.

It can also be an adjective.

This flower is beautiful.

I am hungry.

"Adjective + Noun" can be used as the complement.

It is an interesting story.

We are firm friends.

We can also use "preposition + noun" as the subject complement.

I am on leave today.

His life is in danger.

The cat is on the tree.

### Questions

Verb "to be" + Subject + Complement?

Are you happy?

Is it interesting?

Are they university students?

Is it a cat or a rabbit?

Am I good?

### With Question Words.

Question word + to be + subject?

Who are you?

How old are you?

Where are you from?

What is your name?

Why are you silent?

How far is it to Colombo?

What is the duration of the course?

How long is the interval?

Where is my umbrella?

How much is this shirt?

When is the poya day?

How are you?

## Negative Sentences.

Subject + to be + not + complement.

They are not happy.

I am not interested in cricket.

It is not an easy task.

Too much of sugar is not good for your health.